

PROMISING FUTURE PROJECTS

We delve into the Indian research scene to figure out
some of the most promising projects out there

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It goes without saying that the brain drain crisis is indeed real. Thousands of our brightest minds make their way to foreign universities for seemingly better opportunities. Hence, researching for such an article becomes a tedious process as you come across so few original and noteworthy concepts being researched domestically. Don't get us wrong, there's research, it's just that these don't result in large scale projects all the time. So we delved deeper into some of the most interesting projects that have a deep rooted Indian involvement. Here's what we found.

NAL SARAS

The National Aerospace Laboratories, the second largest aerospace entity in the country after Hindustan Aeronautics Limited has been working on the NAL Saras for quite some time. The Saras will be India's first multi-purpose civilian light transport aircraft. The project commenced back in 1991 in collaboration with Russia. That's a lot of time for a civilian aircraft design, however, the project has had quite a few tragedies along its development timeline. Early on, Russia dropped

out of the collaboration owing to financial troubles with the project and later when India conducted its first nuclear test in 1998, we were hit by US-imposed sanctions that further impacted the timeline. However, NAL persevered and in 2004, three years behind schedule, the Saras completed its first maiden flight.

The second tragedy happened in 2009 when two Indian Air Force pilots and a Flight Test Engineer lost their



lives when the second Saras prototype crashed. NAL put the project on the backburner because of these events and the lack of funding, which stopped in 2013. However, earlier this year, the project was officially revived and the first Saras prototype was reconfigured

before being handed over to the IAF for testing. NAL is confident that the final design will be approved later this year before they can move onto adding two more prototypes to the current fleet.

HYPERLOOP

This one needs no introduction as it has been in the news quite often. Hyperloop, a vactrain technology that was open-sourced by real life Tony Stark i.e. Elon Musk, has been taken up by numerous companies around the world. Each company has commenced work on their own pods. One of these companies, Hyperloop One, has been in talks with multiple government agencies in India to build Hyperloop tracks interconnecting cities and reducing travel time to mere minutes. The Indian Government has been exploring fast travel options such as Bullet Trains for quite some time now and if a Hyperloop system can check all the boxes, then we don't see any reason why it can't be a reality. Hyperloop One has already demonstrated its pod at the DevLoop test track in the Nevada Desert and should the Indian Government decide to go ahead with the Hyperloop concept then we'll be